



**505 Churchgate Chambers, 5 New Marine
Mumbai - 400 020 India.**

Tel: (91 22) 2262 0722 / 24 | Fax: (91 22) 226

Email : info@m.lakhamshi.com | Web : m.la

CIN: L51900MH1985PLC034994

Government Recognised Export House

19.02.2025

Dear

While a large part of the sesame seed trade, exporters, importers, end users and manufacturers of sesame seed based products are dishing out visiting cards at the Gulfood, Dubai trying to generate new leads or sharing a cup of coffee with existing customers, some of us continue to stay put in our offices and focus on the business sitting right here. For those of you, whom I had promised to meet, I tender my apologies.

Moving on to business, the Indian market has been extremely range bound for the last few months as demand and supply are more or less matching. A large part of the pressure has been from Brazilian seed imported into India. Statistics available with me show that in calendar year 2024, India has imported about 100,000 tons of sesame just from Brazil. This is over 40% of Brazilian export of sesame seeds. Clearly this has put pressure on other African origins like Nigeria etc which are otherwise quite popular in India for hulling and re-export. I would add here that pricing was a big factor in the choice made by Indian importers while choosing the origin.

While summer crop planting has started in several parts of Gujarat for whitish and black sesame seeds, we would get a better idea on the planting numbers only after about 4 weeks when all the data is received from the farm levels. As the farmers have limited options for alternate crops for summer and even with the current levels, the levels are still fairly reasonable incentive for farmers to plant sesame seeds. However, at the level of USD. 1100 (+/- USD 50) for imported material, we could see some resistance from Indian farmers in the coming winter season before they decide to plant sesame seeds.

A falling rupee, like several other currencies bore the brunt of a strong dollar. Ironically, this didn't really help support prices or bump up export volumes either as we had a lot of imports being paid for in dollars and with a smaller domestic component of raw material, the eventual change in costing was more a factor of market demand and supply than anything else.

Ramadan is round the corner and it is safe to assume that most of this demand is already covered. Hence we would be left to ship small quantities for Korea on the natural sesame seeds and hulled sesame to most destinations who are still in a mood to buy. A large part of this demand will be catered from the import cargoes and any disruption in the supply or the even the mood to sell what is in

stock could cause markets to jump between USD. 75 – 100 per ton from the current levels. Whether such a jump can sustain or not is another question.

Current levels for sesame seed on a FOB basis for goods to be shipped March – April 2025 are as follows –

Natural Whitish Sortex Sesame seeds , Min 99.95 % purity : USD. 1500.00 pmt

Natural Black Sortex Sesame seeds, Min 99.95 % purity : USD. 2900.00 pmt

Hulled Sesame, Premium, Gujarat, Sortex, Min. 99.98 % Purity : USD. 1750.00 pmt

Hulled Sesame, Premium, Sortex, Min 99.98 % Purity : USD. 1815.00 pmt – FOR EU

Hulled Sesame, Sortex, Min. 99.97 % Purity : USD. 1660.00 pmt

Please revert with your firm interest so we may offer CFR basis as well.

Regards – Sanjiv Sawla

